DDES9903 - Assessment 1 Report

Summary

Memory Organizer

WebGL Link: https://zoeyyy77.itch.io/sleeporganizer

GitHub Link: https://github.com/ZoeyW-zq/9903_Zoey

Scene Name: scene_VR for headset; scene_WebGL for web

Name: Zoey Wu z5658626

Memory Organizer is a short immersive interactive storyboard about repairing an anxious dreamer's subconscious. The player takes the role of a newly hired Memory Organizer on their first assignment. In the office, a robot assistant introduces the job and shows the sleeping Dreamer through a crystal ball. After entering the Dreamer's subconscious, the player organizes recent memories in a hippocampus-inspired memory space, including the Dreamer's experience of going to work while sick. With the assistant's guidance, the player places the memory into a short-term memory box. Just as the task seems under control, the dream world breaks apart and a giant clown appears as a manifestation of the Dreamer's anxiety and internalized pressure. The player is swallowed, enters a space formed by painful memories inside the giant clown, and breaks those memories apart so the Dreamer no longer focuses only on negative experiences. The mission ends with the Dreamer's inner world repaired and the player returning to the office.

Foundation Story

Location

Initial office: the professional starting point of the Memory Organizer's work. The robot assistant introduces the first assignment here, and the crystal ball acts as the threshold into the Dreamer's subconscious.

Hippocampus memory space: the main subconscious workspace where the player reviews what the Dreamer experienced today.

Inside the giant clown's body: a space formed by painful memories gathering together.

Characters / Agents

Player / Memory Organizer: a responsible newcomer on their first day who want to do the job well but are still unfamiliar with the process. Their motivation is professional care: to help the Dreamer reorganize memories.

Robot Assistant: a cute, knowledgeable, and experienced helper. It explains each stage, keeps the player oriented, and adds gentle humor to reduce tension. Its relationship with the player is mentor-like: supportive, practical, and reassuring.

Dreamer: a young person who has just entered the workplace. He is introverted and hardworking, but prone to self-doubt, anxiety, and feelings of inferiority. He is not an enemy; he is the client whose inner world needs care. His relationship to the player is indirect but central, because every space and conflict comes from his memories and emotions.

Giant clown: a manifestation of the Dreamer's negative emotions, internalized pressure, fear of judgment, and the weight of external expectations. It is antagonistic to the player's task, but it is also part of the Dreamer's mind. Its relationship to the Dreamer is symbolic: it is the distorted form of pressure that has grown too loud.

Story Structure

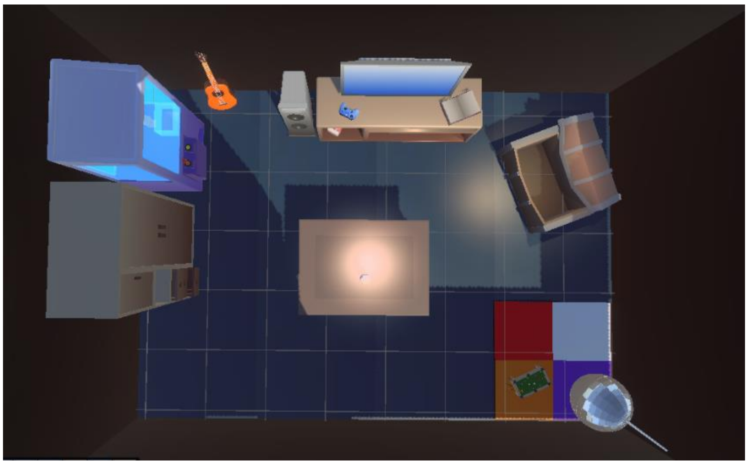
Stage	Intensity	Player experience and evidence
Exposition	2/10	The story begins in the office. The player is introduced as a new Memory Organizer, meets the robot assistant, learns that this is the first assignment, sees the sleeping Dreamer through the screenl, and enters the subconscious by placing a hand on a crystal ball.
Rise / tension building	4/10	In the hippocampus memory space, the player organizes the client's recent memory and learns what happened to him today: he went to work while sick. With prompts from the assistant, the player places this memory into the short-term memory box.
Climax	9/10	After the memory is placed and the task seems close to completion, the crisis appears. The dream world shakes violently, the ceiling cracks or is torn away by a giant hand, and the giant clown overwhelms the workspace, grabs the player and assistant, and swallows them.
Falling action	5/10	The player lands inside the clown body, where painful memories are concentrated in a dungeon-like space.
Resolution / denouement	3/10	The player breaks the glass structures of painful memories, disperses their concentration, repairs the inner world, and returns to the office.

The structure follows Freytag's model while adapting it for an immersive storyboard. The player first understands their role, then performs a manageable memory task, then loses control during the clown interruption, and finally turns crisis into repair. The resolution uses dispersal rather than defeat: painful memories are not deleted, but made less concentrated and less harmful.

Use of Space

The office is arranged as a warm client-facing care space rather than a clinical laboratory. Ryan's distinction between space and place frames this location not as a neutral container, but as an environment with emotional and narrative meaning (Ryan, n.d.). The central table gives the player an obvious orientation point, while the sofa, entertainment objects, ornaments, and domestic details make the room feel less clinical. These objects support the fiction that this is a place for care, conversation, and gentle memory repair.

The hippocampus memory room is designed as a room assembled from objects strongly remembered by the client. For this reason, the items in the space are not arranged with strict visual regularity; they feel like fragments from everyday life that have been kept in memory. Placing the table in the middle guides the player's body and attention: the player naturally moves toward the table, picks up the memory object, watches the memory content, and then places the memory into the box.

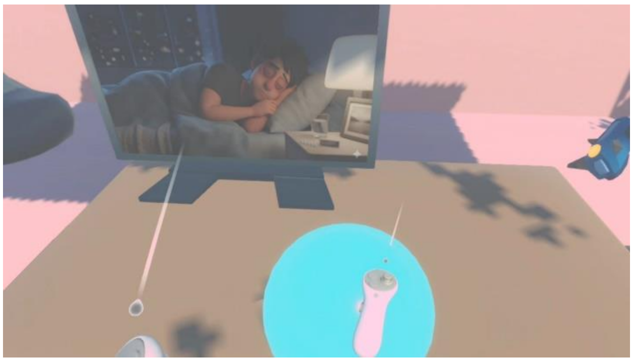


When the clown appears, the environment expands into a hostile exterior with red fog, dark sky, and unsafe scale. The giant hand tearing open the roof makes the player feel small and powerless, which supports the story moment where anxiety overwhelms the ordered memory system. Inside the clown, stone walls, torches, chains, bones, and glass memory structures create a trapped, heavy atmosphere. The player must move through this compressed emotional space before repair becomes possible.

Use of Sensory Triggers / Multimodal Elements

The sensory design uses three distinct **Global Volumes** for different narrative stages, while the robot assistant's voice connects the whole experience. The assistant explains the task, reduces confusion during transitions, and keeps the player aware of the plot when the visuals become unstable.

In the office-to-memory transition, the player places a hand on the crystal ball. This triggers continuous **haptic vibration**, then the view gradually blurs and fades to white. The warm office atmosphere gives way to a sensory threshold, making entry into the client's memory space feel deliberate and believable.



In the memory stage, a separate Global Volume gives the subconscious a blue-purple tone, floating **particles**, and stronger bloom. The particles make the air feel dreamlike, while **spot lights** emphasize the memory object on the table and the short-term memory box. These cues keep the player's attention on the memory workflow rather than on the whole scene equally.

In the crisis stage, the nightmare Global Volume lowers exposure and adds a red vignette. Tension is intensified by layered **audio**: the giant's footsteps, strong heartbeat, tinnitus, the roof being lifted away, and dark background ambience. After the giant clown swallows the player, the screen turns black, but swallowing sounds and the assistant's voice continue so the player still understands the current situation.

Use of Semiotic Elements

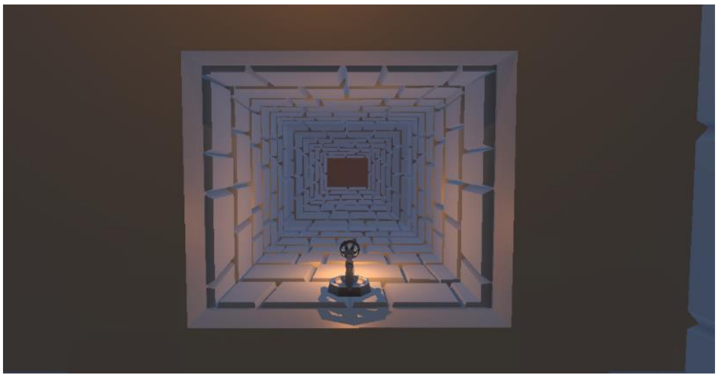
Crystal ball: this fantasy-like object makes the transition into the subconscious feel natural. Instead of using a purely technical interface, the crystal ball suggests vision, diagnosis, and access to hidden mental content.

Memory objects: the physical objects on the table turn invisible mental events into things the player can approach and handle. They make memory organization feel embodied rather than only explained through dialogue.

Memory canvas: when the player picks up an object, the memory canvas shows the specific memory fragment. The design intention is a holographic projection of memory; in the current prototype, a canvas is used as a low-fidelity substitute to communicate that intention.

Giant clown: the clown represents the Dreamer's negative emotions, internalized pressure, and fear of judgment. Its exaggerated scale makes anxiety visible as something that has grown too large and now interrupts the repair work.

After the player is swallowed, the assistant's voice, swallowing sound effects, and the falling-through-a-pipe image work together as signs that communicate a clear new situation: I have been swallowed, and I am now inside the giant's body. This helps the player understand the transition before they begin repairing the painful memory structures inside.



Use of Embodied Actions and/or Enacted Elements

The embodied actions focus on two agents: the player and the giant clown. For the player, the key actions are touching the crystal ball, handling memory objects, placing memory into the short-term memory box, being captured by the giant clown, and breaking painful memory glass. These actions use embodied metaphors, where physical interaction helps the player understand an abstract process through the body (Antle et al., 2009). The crystal ball action starts the journey; the memory sorting action builds confidence; the capture removes control at the climax; and the glass-breaking action resolves the emotional problem.

During the scripted capture, the player's movement is temporarily constrained, but the user can still freely look around in 3D. This reduce agency, but it fits the narrative and physical logic: if a giant has caught and swallowed the player, walking away freely should not be possible. Reduced agency therefore becomes part of the embodied experience of fear, pressure, and loss of control.

The giant clown's actions form the climax. It tears open the roof, reaches into the safe workspace, grabs the player, and swallows them. These actions drive the plot while creating strong visual and auditory shock. The giant scale, roof movement, grab, and layered sound effects make the Dreamer's anxiety feel physically present.

Collaborative Practice

C6-C7:

Zoey Wu Friday 11:40 pm
Hi Ziyi, thank you so much for your suggestion! This is actually something I am struggling with at the moment, because I haven't been able to find a suitable environment that also matches the low-poly style. Your point is very helpful, and I will think about how to make the sleep memory space feel more visually different from the real world. Thanks again for your feedback! ❤️

Zoey Wu Yesterday 1:25 pm
Thank you so much for your suggestion Ziyi! That is a really useful idea! I will keep improving this part in my next version. Thanks again for your helpful feedback, and I really appreciate your support!

Zoey Wu Yesterday 3:17 pm
Hi Yuxiang, thank you for your feedback! I'm glad you liked the story and felt immersed in that moment. I will keep improving the prototype and try to make the final version even better. Thanks again!

Zoey Wu Yesterday 4:21 pm
Hi Feline, I'm happy to hear that you liked the monster designs! The animation was honestly quite a hassle and took me a lot of time to finalise it. I'll keep polishing and improving the prototype for the final version:)

Zoey Wu Yesterday 4:53 pm
Thank u Ruiqing! Your comment really means a lot to me! I'll keep developing the prototype and try to make the refined version feel more complete and polished.

Zoey Wu Yesterday 9:13 pm
Hi Jiaru, I'm really happy that the idea made sense to you! Your comment gives me more confidence that the story direction is working, and I'll keep building on it in the next version.
👍

Zoey Wu Yesterday 9:18 pm
Hi Bruce, I really appreciate your feedback. The idea of showing an "after" scene is very valuable. I'm also planning to expand the story further, possibly with more clients and different storylines. Thanks again for your helpful suggestions!

Hi Junye, thank you so much for your kind words! I'm really glad that the story and characters helped make the experience feel immersive and memorable and left an impression on you. I also really liked your prototype. I think your idea was very creative, and I can tell you've put a lot effort on it. Thanks again for your lovely feedback!

Zoey Wu Yesterday 3:25 pm
Hi Moxin, thank you so much for your helpful suggestion! I will adjust this part based on your feedback, so the final moment can feel more complete and give the player clearer positive feedback and a stronger sense of achievement. Thanks again, I really appreciate it!
❤️

Zoey Wu 2:15 pm
Thank you Lexuan, your comment is really encouraging! I'll keep polishing in the next version

Zoey Wu 5:30 pm
Hi Peiyuan, I'm really glad the crisis moment worked and that the little character felt adorable to you! Thanks for pointing out the edge issue as well. I'll fix that bug in the next version

C1-C5\C12

Zoey Wu 2:12 pm

Hi Moxin, I just ChatGPT your question and here's the reply: I think the main issue is from `SceneViewText.cs`. It seems to use `SceneView`, which is part of the UnityEditor API. This works inside the Unity Editor, but it cannot be included in a WebGL build, so the build fails with a compiler error.

A possible fix is to move this script into an `Editor` folder if it is only used for editor tools, or wrap the UnityEditor/SceneView code with `#if UNITY_EDITOR ... #endif`. If the script is not needed in the final build, disabling or removing it from the build should also solve the problem.

The shadow map messages look more like warnings, not the main reason for the build failure.

Hopefully the answer is helpful, GOOD LUCK

see less

Zoey Wu Yesterday 11:46 pm

Hi Chongyang, I really like your prototype. The hospital scene is very impressive, it feels very complete and believable. I also think your use of lighting changes, visuals, and sound is very effective and helps create a strong atmosphere.

One small suggestion is that clicking the "load room" button before entering the operating room may slightly break the immersion. But overall, I think this is a very strong and well-made prototype.

Zoey Wu 9:31 pm

Thats amazing Feline! Your prototype is really impressive and feels very complete. The visuals are beautiful, and the sound design works so well with the rhythm of the experience. It made me feel fully immersed, not only visually but also emotionally. The whole piece creates a strong sensory impact, and I found it really powerful and memorable. Thank you for bringing me this wonderful experience ❤️

see less

Zoey Wu Yesterday 11:30 pm

I really like your prototype, especially the creative scene design and visual style. The use of small moving spheres to guide the player feels clear and effective, and the spatial audio makes the final scene feel more immersive.

One small suggestion is that the transition when leaving the carriage could be a little smoother, maybe with a simple fade-in or fade-out effect. Overall, it is a very creative and visually engaging experience. 🍀

Zoey Wu 12:31 am

Hi Jake, I really like your prototype. The environment looks beautiful and very complete, and it feels like a lot of care went into the scene design. One small suggestion is that sometimes multiple audio clips seem to be triggered at the same time, which can feel a bit confusing for the player. If the audio triggers are adjusted, I think the experience will feel even clearer and more polished.

see less

Thank you so much for helping me connect the VR headset to my laptop in class today! I really appreciate it 🥹💞

NO PROBLEM:) Im happy I could help

C8-C10

Zoey Wu
2/06 9:57 pm Edited

Week 1 Activity: Ladies First (the first thirty minutes of the film)

1. Background introduction and character setup of Damien. The narrator explains that although Damien appears to have everything—wealth, success, power, and an attractive lifestyle—he is deeply disrespectful toward women and exhibits sexist attitudes.

Structural Components: Exposition
Emotions: Disapproval
Intensity: 4/10

Zoey Wu
17/06 8:59 pm Edited

Week2 Activity___Concept

Background / Concept
This project is about a newly hired **Sleep Organizer** who enters a client's subconscious during sleep to reorganize memory and emotion. The core idea is that anxiety is shaped by attention: negative experiences and external expectations can become louder than quiet but meaningful positive memories.

Agents

- **Player / Sleep Organizer**: A responsible newcomer on their first day. He/she is willing to do the job well, but still unfamiliar with the work process and rely on guidance

Zoey Wu
Friday 11:11 pm

W3

After watching the videos, I chose to review Beyond Eyes. I think this game uses multimodality in a simple but powerful way. The player controls a young blind girl, and the world is not shown clearly at the beginning. Instead, the environment slowly appears through sound, movement and memory.

I think the best part is how the soft watercolour visuals work with the

Zoey Wu
Yesterday 11:58 pm

WEEK5

I explored The Boat and Anne Frank House, and both made me think about how narrative experiences can help audiences understand another person's memories, fears and past experiences. This connects to my own prototype, where the player works as a Sleep Organizer and enters clients' subconscious minds to organise their memories.

In my story, the first client has a nightmare, and the player is swallowed by a giant clown-like figure before breaking the painful memories inside its body. Looking at these examples made me realise that personal memories

Zoey Wu 11:19 am

WebGL Test_MemoryOrganizer

Hi everyone, I made some improvements to my prototype based on the feedback I received before, and I have also created a WebGL version for testing.
MemoryOrganizer by Zoeyyy77
Due to the limited time, I was not able to expand the ending story as much as I wanted, but I will continue to improve and polish it in the future.
I'm still looking forward to your testing and feedback. Thank you!

MemoryOrganizer by Zoeyyy77
Play in your browser
zoeyyy77.itch.io

Zoey Wu Friday 10:58 pm Edited

A1 Prototype_SleepOrganizer

Hi guys. I've finally finished the first version of my prototype🥳

This is a VR game, so I'm unable to publish a WebGL version for everyone to try out directly at the moment. I hope you can give me some feedback and suggestions after watching this video.

The protagonist of this game is a Sleep Organizer. Today is his first day on the job. With the help of a robot assistant, he will enter the subconscious minds of his clients to organize their memories and learn about their life experiences.

I will continue to refine it if I have more time, and try to create a WebGL version later on:)
see more

A1_Demo.mp4

Academic References

Antle, A. N., Corness, G., & Droumeva, M. (2009). What the body knows: Exploring the benefits of embodied metaphors in hybrid physical digital environments. Interacting with Computers, 21(1-2), 66-75. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.intcom.2008.10.005

Cunliffe, A. L., & Coupland, C. (2012). From hero to villain to hero: Making experience sensible through embodied narrative sensemaking. Human Relations, 65(1), 63-88. https://doi.org/10.1177/0018726711424321

Gödde, M., Gabler, F., Siegmund, D., & Braun, A. (2018). Cinematic narration in VR: Rethinking film conventions for 360 degrees. In Virtual, Augmented and Mixed Reality: Applications in Health, Cultural Heritage, and Industry (pp. 184-201). Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-91584-5_15

Ryan, M.-L. (n.d.). Space, place and story. Course reading PDF.

Asset Citations

Audio from Freesound: https://freesound.org/s/753178/ ; https://freesound.org/s/249156/ ; https://freesound.org/s/473525/ ; https://freesound.org/s/643766/ ; https://freesound.org/s/216923/ ; https://freesound.org/s/390549/ ; https://freesound.org/s/377206/

Clown character: Mixamo, https://www.mixamo.com/#/?page=2&type=Character

Picking up animation: Mixamo, https://www.mixamo.com/#/?page=1&type=Motion%2CMotionPack

Unity Asset Store: Stylized Cracking Breakable Glass, https://assetstore.unity.com/packages/vfx/stylized-cracking-breakable-glass-366374

Unity Asset Store: Free Stylized Sci-Fi Scout Bot, https://assetstore.unity.com/packages/3d/characters/robots/free-stylized-sci-fi-scout-bot-371626

Unity Asset Store: Lite Dungeon Pack Low Poly 3D Art by Gridness, https://assetstore.unity.com/packages/3d/environments/dungeons/lite-dungeon-pack-low-poly-3d-art-by-gridness-242692

Unity Asset Store: Raft on the Desert Free Low Poly Pack, https://assetstore.unity.com/packages/3d/environments/landscapes/raft-on-the-desert-free-low-poly-pack-141948

Unity Asset Store: Low Poly Dungeon Lite Fantasy Modular Kit, https://assetstore.unity.com/packages/3d/environments/dungeons/low-poly-dungeon-lite-fantasy-modular-kit-224313

Unity Asset Store: Skybox Series Free, https://assetstore.unity.com/packages/2d/textures-materials/sky/skybox-series-free-103633

EZPZ Interaction Toolkit by Matt Cabanag: https://github.com/mattcabanag ; Unity XR Interaction Toolkit and standard Unity packages were used through the project manifest.

AI Acknowledgements

Google AI Studio Nano Banana 2 Lite was used for image generation. Prompts requested horizontal Disney/Pixar-style 3D cartoon images of a tired young office worker at night with a thermos and medicine, then the same person sleeping in bed at night while maintaining character consistency.

Deevid.ai was used for video generation. The prompt requested a Pixar-inspired single continuous shot of the young office worker at a night desk, noticing medicine, swallowing pills, drinking warm water, and returning to the computer, with consistent character design, simple office background, static camera, natural movement, and cinematic lighting.

ElevenLabs was used to generate the robot assistant voice audio from the written dialogue script, so the assistant narration could remain clear and consistent across scene transitions.

OpenAI Codex was used for code assistance and report support. Prompts asked for implementation help based on current scripts and process analysis, debugging suggestions, rubric comparison, structure revision, and concise wording. Final design decisions, editing, asset selection, and submission responsibility remain my own.